



6th Grade English Language Arts

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · COURSE SYLLABUS · 2026–2027

Full Year · Grade 6

FACILITATOR

[Teacher Name]

FLORIDA COURSE

Florida 1001010 (M/J Language Arts 1) · Full-year course

GRADE LEVEL

Grade 6 (Middle School)

EMAIL & OFFICE

[teacher email address] · 239.673.2801 (OAO Front Office)

OFFICE HOURS

[Add your weekly office hours here]

FORMAT

On-Demand (also offered live on the VR campus)

About this syllabus. This is the plan for the course as designed. It is a full-year middle-school course; On-Demand scholars pace through the six modules across the two semesters of their enrolled year. On-Demand and live-school sections share the same content and expectations; exact pacing, scheduled dates, and a few activities may vary from section to section and term to term. Your facilitator will confirm the specifics for your section.

COURSE OVERVIEW

6th Grade English Language Arts leads the scholar through six modules of classic story: a saint's legend of courage and truth, poems and a myth that argue with the reader, the knights of Camelot and the cost of a code of honor, the outlaw of Sherwood Forest and the line between law and justice, a novel of first-century Galilee about what love can do that hatred cannot, and two of Shakespeare's plays retold by Charles and Mary Lamb. Each week runs on a steady rhythm: three literature lessons, two grammar-and-vocabulary lessons (each closing with a short auto-graded quiz), and one workshop day for writing and a solo VR activity. Scholars keep a single Reading Journal in Microsoft Word all year, practice copia (rewriting a sentence from the reading in their own words), notice a craft term and then use it themselves, and build toward one substantial teacher-graded essay or project each module — a time capsule, a letter answering an author, a knight-comparison essay, a hero's portrait, an argument from evidence, and a final essay on what from the whole year is worth carrying forward. By the end of the year a scholar should read a 6th-grade text closely, support a claim with evidence and sound reasoning, and recognize the moves of figurative language and rhetoric in what they read.

WHAT SCHOLARS WILL LEARN TO DO

- Analyze how the interaction between characters develops a plot, and how a theme develops across a literary text.
- Explain how figurative language — metaphor, simile, personification, hyperbole, idiom — shapes tone and meaning.
- Write and support a claim using logical reasoning, relevant textual evidence, and a clear organizational structure.
- Write a personal or fictional narrative using narrative techniques, precise words, and figurative language.
- Paraphrase a text accurately and cite evidence to explain or defend an interpretation.
- Apply standard English grammar, punctuation, capitalization, and spelling appropriate to sixth grade.
- Apply knowledge of Greek and Latin roots and affixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words.
- Identify the rhetorical appeals of logos, ethos, and pathos in an argument.
- Use digital tools (Microsoft Word, OneDrive) to plan, draft, revise, and submit writing.
- Discuss a text with classmates by citing what it actually says.

BIG PROJECTS & MILESTONES

The course builds toward a set of finished, real-world artifacts. Target dates below follow a **sample full-year pacing**; On-Demand scholars pace to their own enrolled term and Live sections follow the class schedule, keeping each milestone roughly in order.

PROJECT / MILESTONE	COURSE PLACE	SAMPLE TARGET	WHAT YOU TURN IN
St. George and the Dragon — Time Capsule	Module 1 · Weeks 1–6	by Sep 25	A multi-part Word document "time capsule" of artifacts and written reflections interpreting the novel, built across the module and submitted via the Canvas OneDrive tab.
"Dear Author, I Disagree" — Refutation Letter	Module 2 · Weeks 7–10	by Oct 23	A counter-argument letter that states an author's claim fairly, then refutes it with reasoning and textual evidence, plus a recorded spoken rebuttal and a Canvas discussion post.
"What Makes a Good Knight?" — Comparison Essay	Module 3 · Weeks 11–16	by Dec 18	A 5–6 paragraph essay comparing two knights from the text and arguing what makes a knight good, paired with a solo VR knight gallery.
"Portrait of a Hero" — Essay & VR Composition	Module 4 · Weeks 17–24	by Mar 5	A 700–900 word analytical essay on heroism and justice, plus a companion Forest Court VR composition, built through six weekly Quick Writes.
"The Power of Choice: Daniel's Journey" — Essay	Module 5 · Weeks 25–29	by Apr 30	A 4–5 paragraph expository/argumentative essay using the rhetorical appeals (logos, ethos, pathos) to trace a character's change from hatred to love.
"What Lasts" — Comparative Essay & VR Reflection	Module 6 · Weeks 30–32	by May 28	A 200–250 word essay connecting one theme (heroism, self-sacrifice, happiness, or duty) across at least three texts from the whole year, plus a 2–3 minute recorded VR oral reflection.

IMPORTANT DATES — 2026–2027

Aug 12, 2026	First day of school	Sep 7	Holiday (Labor Day)
Oct 9	Quarter 1 ends	Oct 12	Holiday (Columbus Day)
Nov 11	Holiday (Veterans' Day)	Nov 23–27	Thanksgiving break
Dec 18	Quarter 2 ends · fall semester ends	Dec 21–Jan 1	Winter break
Jan 5, 2027	Classes resume	Jan 18	Holiday (MLK Day)
Feb 15	Holiday (Presidents' Day)	Mar 5	Quarter 3 ends
Mar 26–Apr 5	Spring break	Apr 6	Classes resume
May 28, 2027	Quarter 4 ends · last day of school	May 31	Holiday (Memorial Day)

ASSESSMENT & GRADING

60% Daily Practice & Material (weekly quizzes, vocabulary checks, VR completion, Reading Journal Checks)	25% Discussions & Reflection (Canvas Discussions, module outro wrappers)	15% Module Projects (one major, teacher-graded essay or project per module)
--	--	---

HOW THIS COURSE IS DELIVERED

This course is offered in two formats that share the same content, assignments, and expectations: an **On-Demand (asynchronous)** section you pace yourself, and a **Live (synchronous)** section that meets on a schedule on Optima's VR campus. The two overviews below explain how each one works. Find the one that matches your enrollment.

ON-DEMAND (ASYNCHRONOUS) LEARNING

In the **On-Demand** section you move through the course at your own pace within each quarter, guided by due dates that keep you on track. All assignments for a quarter open at its start and close at its end. Because the course is On-Demand, there is no grade penalty for missing an individual due date — but any assignment not completed by the end of the quarter receives a **zero**, and assignments submitted in the final **14 days** of a quarter receive a **10% deduction**, so steady pacing matters.

Attendance is measured by assignment completion. Per school policy, a scholar who completes no assignment for ten consecutive school days, without notifying the school of an absence in advance, may be dropped from the course. Completion means a **sincere attempt** — real effort on real work. Rushed work, wrong or corrupted files, irrelevant or nonsense submissions, AI-generated filler, and word-salad responses do not count.



You are never on your own. A live facilitator grades your work, gives feedback, and hosts a weekly study hall and VR workshops.

LIVE (SYNCHRONOUS) LEARNING

In the **Live** section you join scheduled class meetings on Optima's VR campus, where your teacher leads instruction in real time and you learn alongside classmates. The readings, assignments, and projects are the same as the On-Demand course; what differs is the pacing — a Live section moves through the material together on the class schedule rather than at each scholar's own pace, and class time is also used for discussion, questions, and guided practice.

Attendance is measured by presence and participation. You are expected to attend the scheduled live sessions, on time and ready to take part. If you must miss a class, notify the school in advance; your teacher will let you know how to make up the work and any material you missed. As in every Optima course, completing your work means a **sincere attempt** — real effort on real work — and assignments still open and close with each quarter.



You meet regularly with a teacher. The class gathers throughout the week in VR and on Microsoft Teams for live instruction and discussion.

APPROPRIATE USE OF AI

Optima scholars are preparing for a world shaped by artificial intelligence, and learning to use these tools with good judgment is part of that preparation. You are welcome to use AI tools to **support** your learning — to explain a concept a different way, check your understanding, or brainstorm — unless a particular assignment says otherwise. What AI may **never** do is the thinking or the work an assignment asks of you: a reflection, a self-assessment, a resume, an essay, or a discussion post must be genuinely your own. Submitting AI-generated text as if it were your own work is dishonest and, as noted above, counts as an insincere attempt. When you do use an AI tool on an assignment, say so briefly. Above all, build the underlying skill yourself — the goal is for you to be able to judge whether an AI's answer is any good, which you can only do if you can do the work without it.

LEARNING IN VIRTUAL REALITY

Optima is a virtual-reality school. Alongside your Canvas coursework, you will join immersive sessions on Optima's VR campus, where you meet teachers and fellow scholars, take part in live activities, and explore places and ideas you could not visit in an ordinary classroom. Keep your headset charged and ready for any scheduled VR sessions, and treat the VR campus with the same courtesy and seriousness you would a physical one. If you ever cannot get into VR for a session, tell your facilitator — there is an alternative way to take part so you do not fall behind.

BEING AN OPTIMA SCHOLAR

Optima's mission is an excellent, virtue-centered education, and virtue is at the center of this course as much as any other. Every scholar is expected to practice the seven virtues that shape life at Optima — **courage, courtesy, honesty, perseverance, self-government, service, and responsibility**. In practice that means: do your own honest work; treat everyone you meet in, through, or because of this course with respect, in writing, in discussion, and in VR; engage actively rather than passively; come to office hours to get help, meet other scholars, and get to know your facilitator; and take responsibility for your own pacing and progress. You belong to a house and a community of scholars, not only to a course.

WHAT YOU NEED & STAYING CONNECTED

- ✓ A computer with reliable internet and access to **Canvas**.
- ✓ A **VR headset**, charged and ready for the weekly solo VR activities.
- ✓ **Microsoft 365** (Word) with OneDrive, for the Reading Journal and every graded piece of writing.
- ✓ Own copies of the four in-copyright novels: **St. George and the Dragon** (Lotti), **King Arthur and His Knights of the Round Table** (Green), **The Adventures of Robin Hood** (Green), and **The Bronze Bow** (Spear). The two non-public-domain poems, "The Tale of Custard the Dragon" (Nash) and "Do Not Go Gentle into That Good Night" (Thomas), also require the scholar's own copy or anthology. Hawthorne's "The Golden Touch" and the Lamb *Tales from Shakespeare* selections are public domain and provided in the course.
- ✓ A bound **writing notebook** for handwritten copywork and grammar practice.
- ✓ Notecards for vocabulary, and pens, pencils, and erasers.

Staying connected. Updates about this course are posted on the course's **Canvas** page; school-wide updates are posted in your **Homeroom Canvas** course. Check both regularly. Your facilitator holds office hours and is glad to help with the material, to meet you, or to talk through your plans — come by, or reach out any time by email.